

Muncie Fire Merit Commission April 9, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6wDWJm7vznQ
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2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Andrew Dale called the regular meeting of the Muncie Fire Merit Commission to order on April 9th, 2026 **00:00:05**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Victoria Rose (Rowles), Andrew Dale, Linda Gray, Mike Widen (White), Chief Burford, and Mark Ervin (Counsel).
 - **Absent:** Shannon Coyle.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not explicitly noted in the transcript.
- **Approval of Minutes:** **00:00:35** The minutes from the March 12th, 2026 Muncie Fire Merit Commission meeting were motioned, seconded, and approved by voice vote.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:04 Chief's Report & Certifications**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Burford
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Chief Burford presented the monthly certifications list, noting that two previously appointed recruits cleared all background and PERF

requirements and started recruit school on Monday.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board action required.
- **00:01:54 Benjamin Wren Disciplinary Matter & Court Remand**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Councilor Mark Ervin
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Councilor Ervin updated the commission on Judge Fife's order regarding the Benjamin Wren disciplinary matter, which remanded the case back to the Merit Commission and department to ensure a proper investigation was conducted. Discussion ensued regarding local ordinance governance (Title 19) versus state statute (Title 36), and the board discussed compliance with the court order.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 4-0 via roll call vote directing Chief Burford to compile a timeline and information regarding how the investigation was conducted within 20 days.
- **00:07:38 Proposed Changes to Rule and Procedure Number 8**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioner Mike White / President Andrew Dale
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Commissioner White proposed removing subsection C from Section 9 of Rule 8 to eliminate contradictions regarding the recalculation of attendance and seniority points at the time of a vacancy (superseded by a 2009 rule keeping scores locked upon list certification).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to prepare the rule change notice for circulation and introduction to members.
- **00:11:04 Certification of the 2026 Recruitment List**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Burford / Commission Body
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The commission reviewed the new candidate list. Discussion clarified that the list must be certified in whole, while conditions of employment (such as background checks, PERF, and the pass/fail ladder climb) operate as contingencies.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 4-0 via roll call vote to certify the 2026 recruitment list as presented.
- **00:13:42 Certification of the Promotions List (Deferred)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Burford
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The commission noted that action on the 2026 promotions list cannot be taken yet as final tabulation checks and score clarifications are still being finalized with IPSP.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Deferred to a future meeting.
- **00:15:12 Addition of Urgent Agenda Item: Appointment to the Muncie Fire Department**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Burford / Commission Body
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Chief Burford requested an added agenda item due to a recent resignation letter submitted by Firefighter Miles Waters (effective April 26th), which created an immediate opening.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to add the appointment item to the agenda.
 - **00:16:05 Appointment of New Firefighter (Nimway Rye Miller)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Burford
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Following the resignation of Firefighter Waters, Chief Burford requested the commission pull from the newly certified list. He recommended Nimway Rye Miller<U+2014>a current civilian paramedic with the department who finished at the top of the new list<U+2014>for appointment to the Muncie Fire Department to join the active recruit academy.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 4-0 via roll call vote approving the appointment of Nimway Rye Miller.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:20:52 Floor opened for public comment:** No members of the public came forward to speak.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Chief Burford noted post-meeting administrative steps for the newly appointed firefighter.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was motioned, seconded, and approved by voice vote to adjourn **00:21:03**.
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